



△ Paris, France

Paris expanded rapidly from the 1840s due to the arrival of the railroads. During the 1850s, Napoleon III ordered a massive remodeling by Georges Haussmann, who replaced entire medieval districts of narrow, cramped streets with the wide boulevards, such as this one, for which the city is now famous.

World's biggest cities

These graphs show the extraordinary population growth in the world's top five cities. The list of top cities changes between 1800 and 1900 from mainly Asian cities to European and American ones.



△ Chicago

By 1900, thanks to industry and railways, Chicago was the second-largest American city. Good transport links encouraged trade, such as markets, like this one on South Water Street.

factors: the spread of mass production, which reduced costs and thus lowered retail prices; the availability of the technology for mass entertainment such as cinema (see pp.344–45); the concentration of people in the cities to consume products and entertainment; and the fact that by 1900, for the first time, standards of living in the industrial West had risen so significantly that most people had some disposable income.

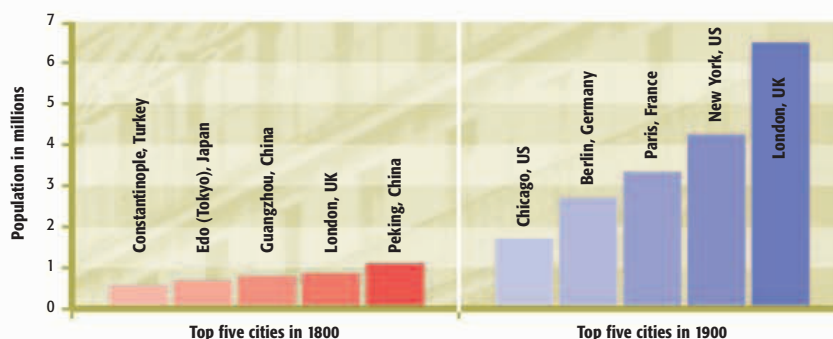
Not only were people earning more money, but the focus of their lives was undergoing a gradual shift away from the workplace—average working hours were shorter, leading to a division between work and leisure time. Rising

income enabled people to decide what they did with that spare time. By the early 20th century, a wide range of diversions were available, including popular theater, music hall, motion pictures, and professional sports. Much of this entertainment directly or indirectly used the technologies whose development had led to urban growth: directly, in developments such as cinema, and indirectly in that railroads and transportation systems improved people's access to these leisure facilities.

3 PERCENT The proportion of the global population living in towns of over 200,000 people in 1800.

15 PERCENT by 1900.

30 PERCENT by 1950.



Cities continue to expand, draining rural areas of their population, concentrating wealth, and creating new benefits and problems.

CONTINUED GROWTH

The number of people worldwide living in cities has **continued to rise** since the medieval period.

6.2 MILLION The average size of the world's 100 largest cities in 2000.

SLUMS AND SHANTIES

As urbanization continued to accelerate during the 20th century, the new phenomenon of the shanty town appeared on the **fringes of cities** in Africa, Asia, and South America, where there is a **wide gap between rich and poor**. Shanty towns are haphazard collections of unlicensed **makeshift houses** that are built from any available waste materials. The rural poor are drawn to shanty towns in the hopes that living **close to the city** might bring them employment, housing, health services, education, and utilities, but for the vast majority it is a false hope. Conditions are far worse than those they have left behind in the country, with hunger and poverty made worse by crime and disease. According to the United Nations, more than half the world's population now lives in cities, almost one-third of that number in slum areas or shanty towns.



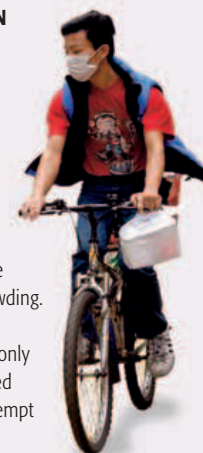
SHANTY TOWN LIFE

LIGHT POLLUTION

In urban areas, problems are caused by an **excess of artificial light**. These include adverse effects on human health and disruption of ecosystems governed by sunlight.

INNER CITY CONGESTION

During the 20th century, the problems of overcrowding in cities changed from those encountered during the 19th century. Problems of food supply and sanitation were replaced by those of **pollution and traffic congestion**, together with the perennial problem of overcrowding. Long a feature of third-world cities, bicycles are now commonly seen on the roads of developed first-world cities as people attempt to reduce pollution and find a quick route through the congestion **474–75** >>



A CITY CYCLIST

12 MPH The average speed of traffic in London in the year 1900 and in the year 2000.